



just DOT it.

AI that turns procrastination into progress.



Your Own AI Momentum
Coach

Get moving in under 60
seconds

Focus on a single intention,

NextLeap

CHALLENGE

Many young professionals juggle multiple productivity tools, but procrastination still gets in the way. Tasks pile up, reminders lose their impact, and the result is guilt, overwhelm, and avoidance.

POSSIBLE SOLUTION

A minimalist AI Momentum Coach that helps young professionals overcome the emotional hurdle of starting by breaking big goals into one small daily win.

“How might we help young professionals overcome the emotional hurdle of starting, and make progress feel simple and achievable?”

These tools optimise for storing tasks, not completing them. The result? Young professionals struggle to turn daily intentions into small, achievable wins. **Why is getting started still the hardest part?**

DESK RESEARCH

2x2 Matrix of Productivity Solutions

Quick Fixes

Simple but Limited

- Pomodoro technique
- "Eat That Frog"
- Easy to start
- Good for short tasks

Foolproof Zone

Comprehensive + Easy

- GTD when simplified
- Practical systems
- Sustainable approach
- Best place to be

Traps

Limited + Impractical

- Minute-by-minute scheduling
- Interesting concepts
- Not realistic daily life
- Quick to abandon

Heavyweights

Comprehensive but Hard

- Stephen Covey's 7 Habits
- Very powerful systems
- Can feel overwhelming
- Complex for daily use

Source found this amazing source.

Assumptions

Procrastination is a **time management** issue.
The right **productivity hack** or system is the solution.
Users need better tools for **organising their tasks**.

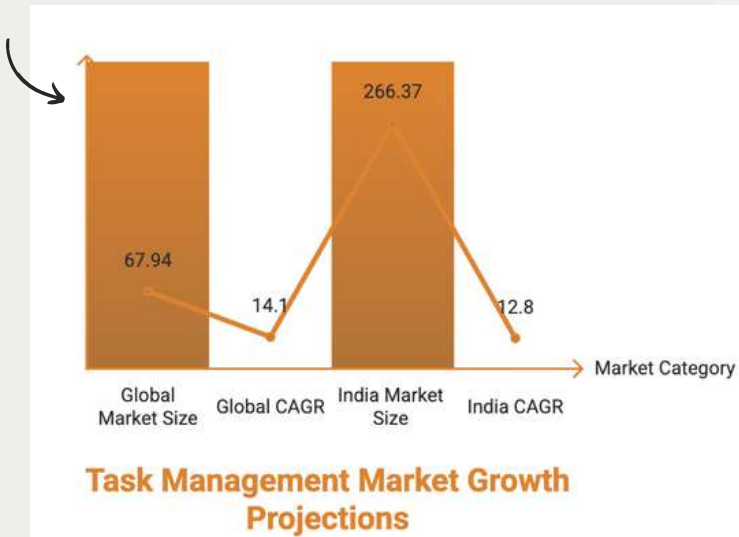


Books i found interesting

Opportunity

Project managing apps **overwhelm**.
Gamified apps **distract**.
No tool tackles the hardest part-
getting started.

Market



Sources
Ken Research
Grand View Research

Competitor Analysis

Todoist (4.5★)

Clean design, powerful organization but focuses on planning, not action

Asana (4.7★)

Great for teams, but too complex for personal use, heavy interface creates friction

TickTick (4.8★)

Combines to-dos with calendar view, but still task-heavy, doesn't solve "getting started"

Habitica (4.2★)

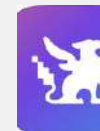
Gamifies tasks, but can become procrastination itself, too juvenile for some users

Forest (4.8★)

Helps build focus by blocking phone use, but solves distraction, not initiation

Key Gap Identified

No tool specifically addresses the emotional battle of getting started – the most difficult moment in productivity.



Findings

I'm convinced 99% of productivity apps are designed to fail you.

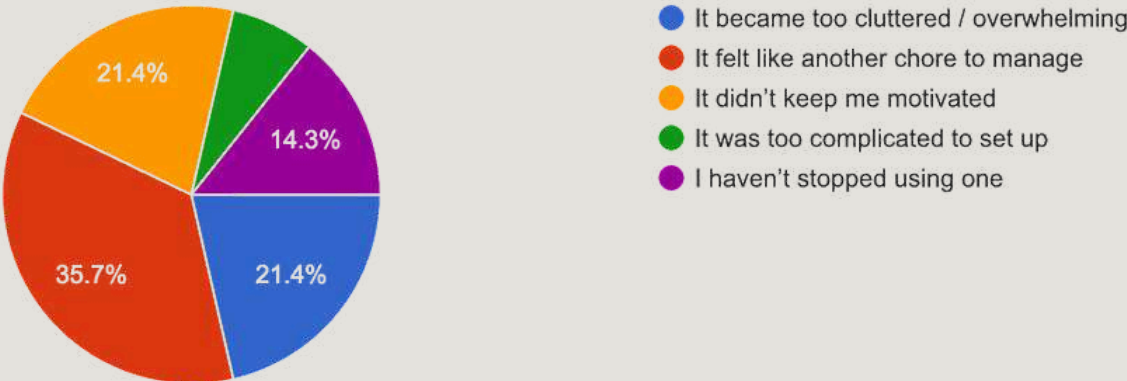
Source Reddit r/productivity

USER SURVEY & INTERVIEW INSIGHTS

Survey Findings

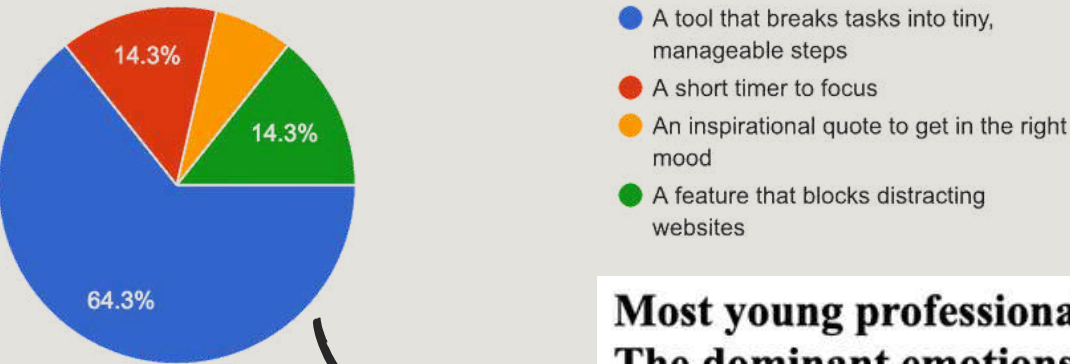
What is the main reason you've stopped using a productivity app in the past?

14 responses



Imagine an app could help you with the 'getting started' part of a task. What feature would help the most?

14 responses



Insights

Most young professionals struggle most with getting started on big tasks. The dominant emotions linked to procrastination are anxiety and overwhelm, not lack of time. Users are more motivated by simple encouragement and visible progress than by gamified points or leaderboards.

Rationale

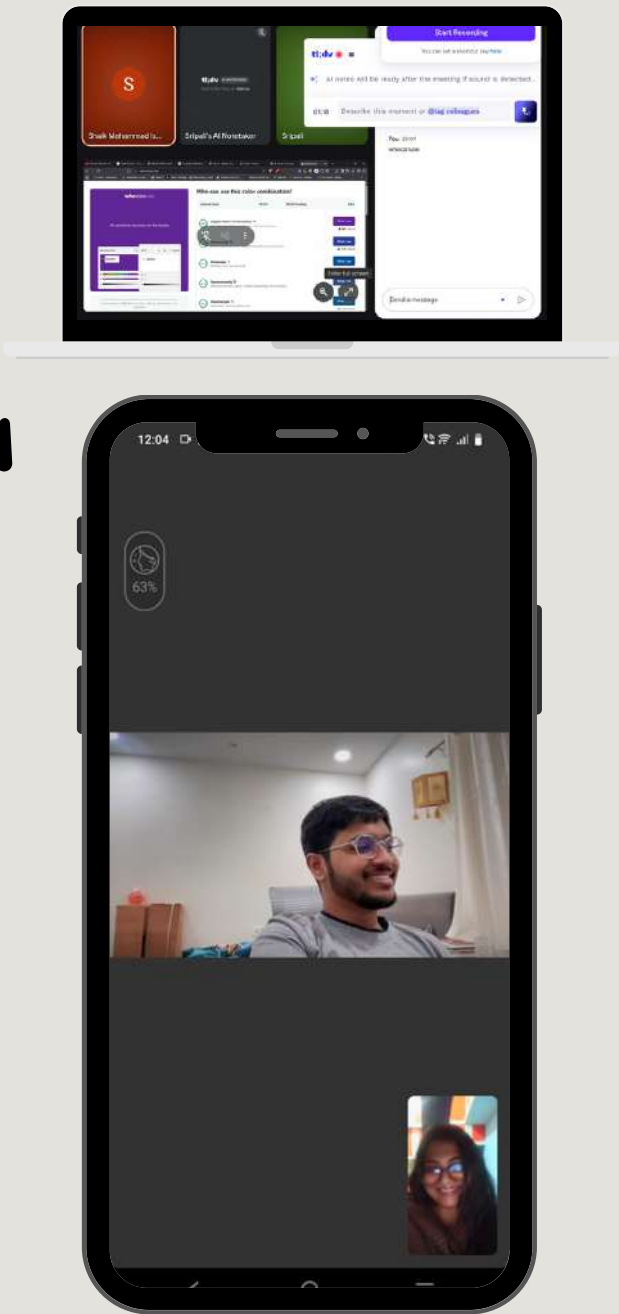
Peer-based solutions were invalidated, showing the need for a different approach. Justified creating a non-judgmental AI buddy for consistent, empathetic support. “Dot” combines system reliability with partner-like empathy, offering a safe space for honest progress tracking.

The person who was supposed to help became another source of anxiety. I felt too embarrassed to tell them I made zero progress, so I just started avoiding their texts.

‘It's the blank page, the empty Figma file... If someone could just tell me the one tiny, stupidly simple thing to do first, I know I could get going’

My to-do app isn't a tool, it's a 'wall of shame' for everything I haven't done. I open it and I'm instantly paralysed

Interview Findings



THE MAIN PERSONA

“I know I need to 'work on my poster series,' but that's so vague. The thought of opening Illustrator and facing a blank canvas is exhausting.”

Bio:

Aryan is a 27-year-old freelance graphic designer. He's talented, ambitious, and has a growing list of clients. He's a master of using tools like Asana and Trello for client deadlines, but his real passion is a personal project: a series of illustrated posters he wants to sell online.

Goals:

- To launch his own online print shop within the next six months.
- To build a personal brand that showcases his unique artistic style.
- To feel a sense of creative fulfillment outside of his client work.

Motivations:

- Values simplicity and clarity in tools, not complexity.
- Desires a sense of momentum and achievement to stay motivated.

Frustrations:

- Personal tasks feel like extra obligations inside work tools, so they get ignored.
- Big goals feel vague and unstartable, leading to endless avoidance.
- Accountability with friends creates guilt and fear of letting them down.
- Waiting for inspiration means tasks keep getting pushed off.

He said yes to the hat, I promise



Assumptions

Before (Hypotheses):

- Procrastination = time issue.
- Hacks/systems = solution.
- Better tools = answer.

After (Realities):

- Procrastination = emotion issue (anxiety, doubt, fear).
- Hacks fail when emotions overwhelm.
- More organization = “wall of shame,” fuels avoidance.

I can't help but share

“I told my friend I'd have three posters done this week. It's Sunday night, and I'm suddenly very good at avoiding their texts”

“I sat down to design my poster series... and ended up colour-coding my Google Drive folders for two hours. At least my files look great.”

Empathy Map



IDEATION

Based on our insights, I led an ideation session to explore potential solutions, which we then prioritized using the RICE framework to ensure our MVP was focused, impactful, and feasible.

01

AI Companion

Intelligent personal productivity coach that learns your patterns, provides contextual guidance, and keeps you motivated throughout your DOT journey.

PRIORITY #1

"The brain that makes everything else work better - turning productivity from a struggle into a supported journey."

Why AI Companion is Priority #1

The AI Companion is the multiplier that makes features #2 and #3 exponentially more valuable. It transforms raw analytics into actionable insights and turns streak data into personalized motivation. Without the AI layer, users get information - with it, they get transformation.

Design prioritizes emotional barriers over productivity mechanics - because the problem isn't organizing tasks, it's getting humans to actually do them.



02

Progress Analytics

Comprehensive tracking of productive vs. non-productive days, task initiation rates, and completion patterns across all DOT categories.

"Data-driven insights that reveal your productivity DNA and guide smarter decisions."

03

Streaks

Continuous day tracking for task completion that gamifies consistency and builds momentum through visual progress and achievement rewards.

"The addiction engine that transforms good habits into unstoppable momentum."

RICE

Feature Comparison

AI Companion

Progress Analytics

Streaks



Reach



Impact



Confidence



Effort

Every user benefits

High

High

Medium

Wide

Medium

Medium

Medium

Narrower

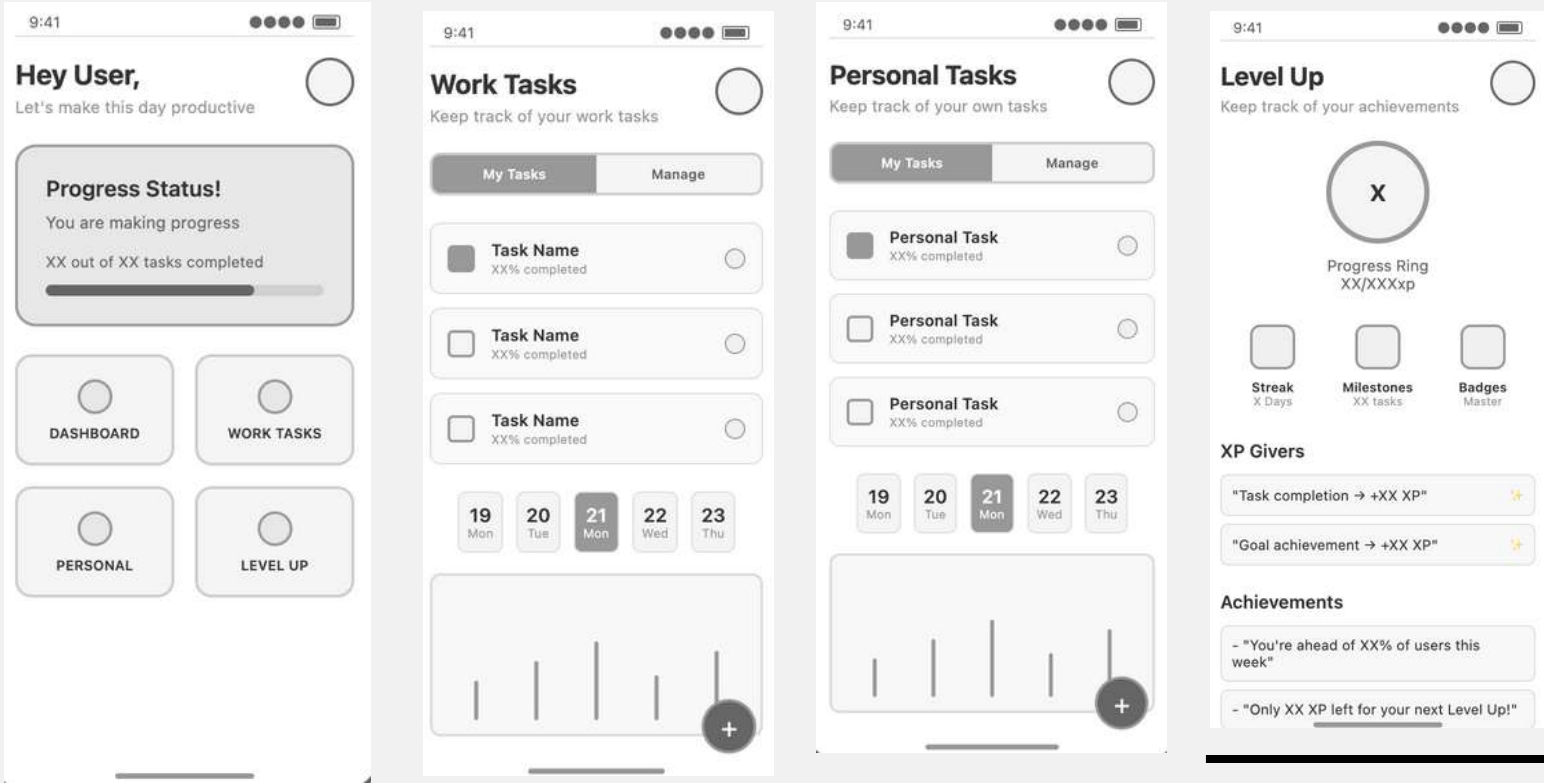
Medium

Medium

Low

EVOLUTION OF DESIGNS & DECISIONS

MID-FIDELITY



HIGH-FIDELITY

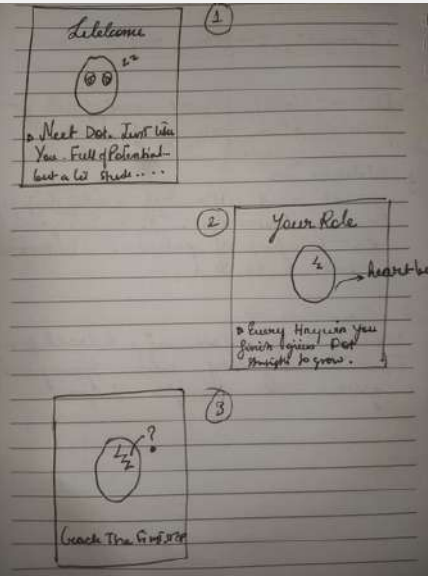


Rewards

Your Own AI Momentum Coach

Progress tracking using analytics

IDEAS DISCARDED

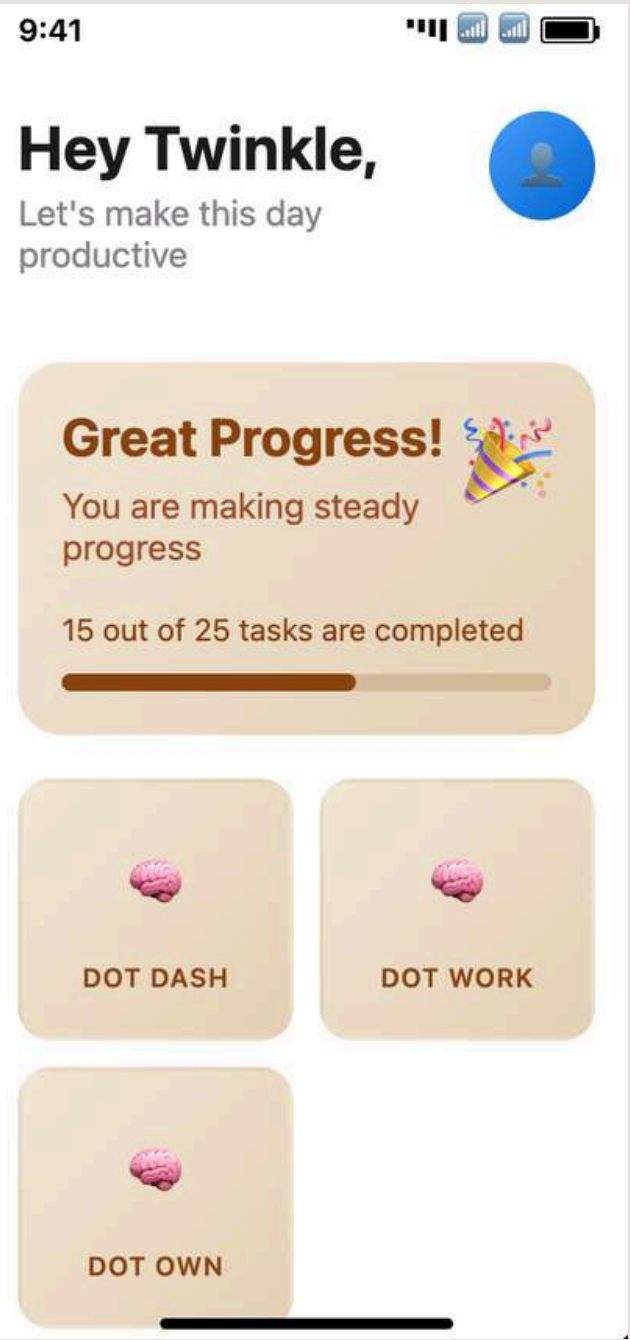


Thought of adding stories but it became too verbose, will take time to load the animations

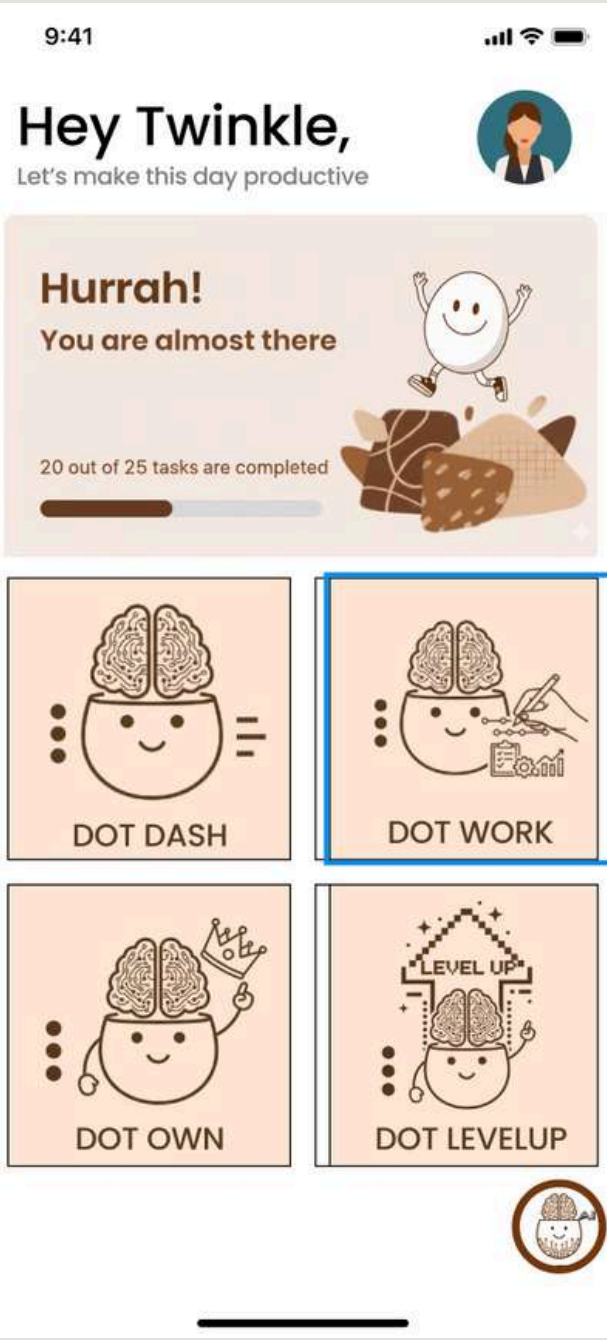
USER FLOW

Home → (Choose section) → Task Progress / Tracking → Motivation (Level Up)

USABILITY TESTING & ITERATIONS



BEFORE



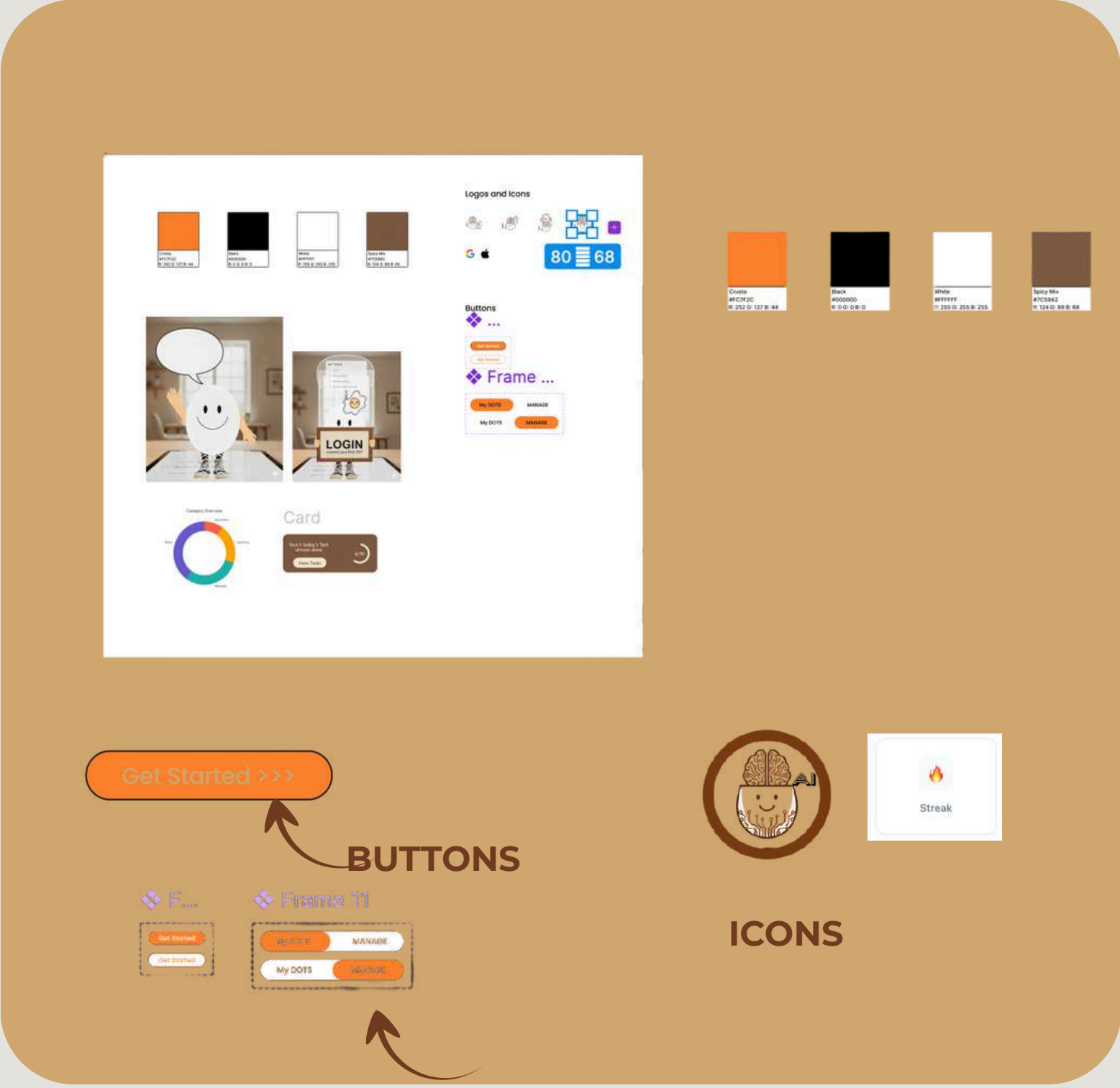
AFTER

Improved message

2x2 Grids for symmetry

Added DOT levelup for streaks

STYLE GUIDE

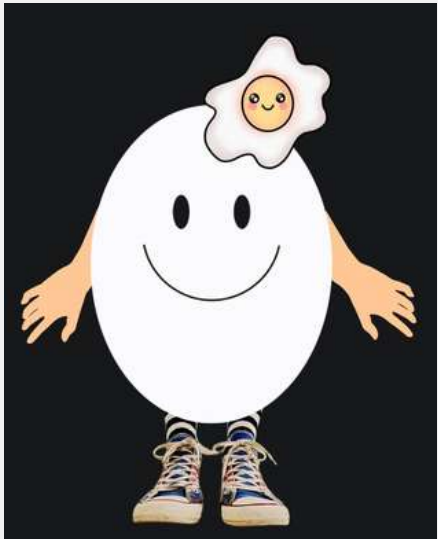
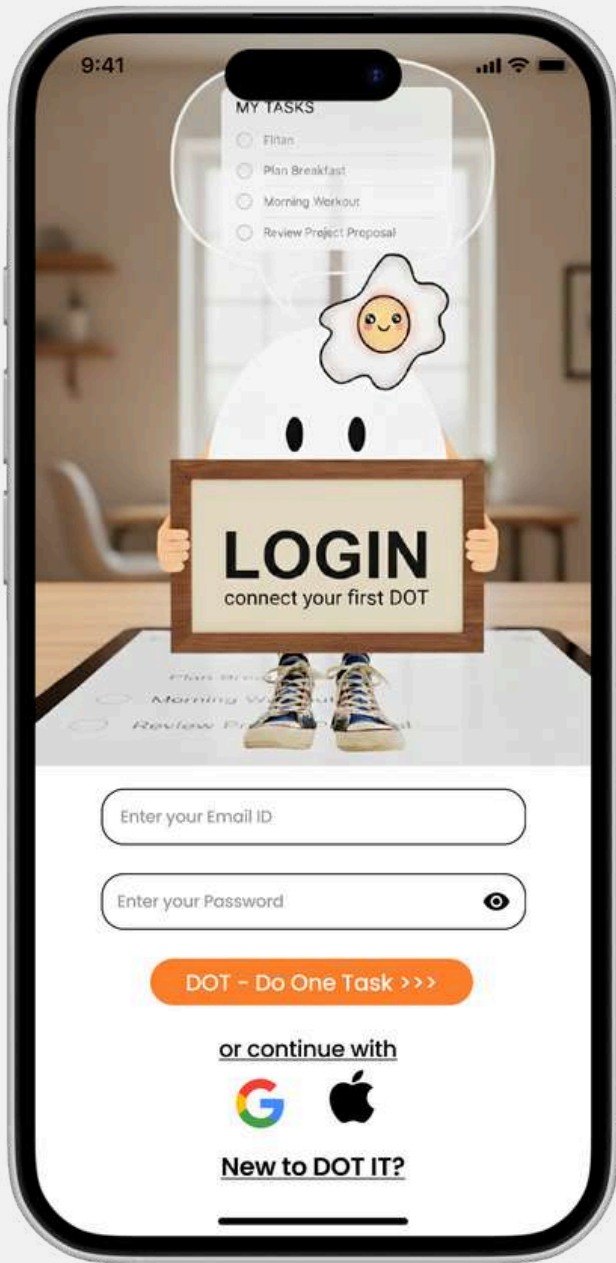


BUTTONS

ICONS

COMPONENTS

THE FINAL PROTOTYPE



PROTOTYPE

TRY DOT IT. NOW

ANY FEEEDBACK IS
APPRECIATED

Pitfalls and Mitigations

The AI Feels Generic or Creepy	Compassionate, non-intrusive personality for <i>Dot</i> .
Users "Cheat" the System	Intentionally subtle reward system to motivate by improvement, not reward
Users "Cheat" the System	"Intention Funnel" design, with the "Later List," directly address this

Next Steps

- Ship MVP as a mobile app
- Monitor usage of features to validate hypothesis
- Continuous refining of AI coach’s language to make it more empathetic

Future Scope

- The dot.it Chrome Extension:
- Optional Human Accountability partner
- Proactive AI Coaching

Reflections

- Design for emotions, not just functions
- “How many things can the users do?” to “How can we make it safe and easy to do just one thing?”